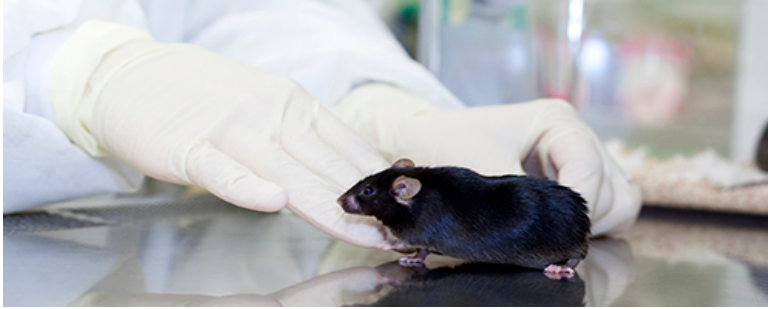




# Office of Research & Development

## VA Animal Research Program



*Animal research has saved the lives of millions of Veterans, and will continue to do so.*

[Overview](#) of Animal Research in VA

To conduct the research needed to improve medical care, we sometimes have to work with animal models. Studying animals is still the only scientifically viable way to get some of the knowledge we need to improve human health, and indeed the health of other animals that benefit from veterinary care. VA allows research with animals only if it is scientifically necessary and if animal-welfare safeguards are adhered to.

### The VA PTSD/Service Dog Study

As authorized by Congress, VA completed a study to determine if service dogs can help Veterans with PTSD. [Read about this study.](#)

#### ABOUT ANIMAL RESEARCH IN VA

- [Animal Research Overview](#)
- [Animal Research FAQ](#)
- [Canine Research](#)
- [Animal Research Fact Sheet](#)
- [Research Day Poster](#)

#### MORE ABOUT ANIMAL RESEARCH

- [Americans for Medical Progress](#)
- [Foundation for Biomedical Research](#)
- [National Association for Biomedical Research](#)
- [FASEB Briefing](#)
- [Speaking Up for the Value of Animal Research](#)
- [Speaking of Research](#)

### Resources for Administrators and Researchers

#### RESEARCH GUIDANCE

- [Annual Continuing Review of Protocols](#)
- [Technical Summaries](#)
- [Criteria for NSM and NAM](#)
- [Drafting an MOU](#)

[More Guidance](#)

#### RELATED DOCUMENTS

- [Use of Animals in Research](#)
- [Forms for Semiannual Evaluations of the Institutional Care](#)
- [Contracting Documents](#)
- [Animal Component of Research](#)

[More Documents](#)

## News About Animal Research

### VA Research Currents and VA news releases

[Lab studies seek hormone-based obesity treatment](#) (Jan. 18, 2022)

[Brain trauma: Combined treatment improves cell connectivity in important memory center of the brain.](#) (Oct. 30, 2020)

[Does smoking block potential benefits from stem cell therapy?](#) (Sept. 1, 2020)

[Lab study suggests way to stem long-term damage after brain injury](#) (June 11, 2020)

[Lab study: E-cigarettes may damage body's ability to fight infection](#) (Jan. 15, 2020)

[Comprehending the effects of blasts](#) (June 27, 2019)

[+ More](#)

### VA Research news briefs

[E-cigarettes may weaken muscle strength and healing](#) (Nov. 3, 2022)

[Bacteria transplantation could treat alcohol use disorder](#) (Oct. 27, 2022)

[Potential new treatment for cocaine use disorder](#) (Dec. 27, 2021)

[Daily fasting could improve metabolic health, suggests mouse study](#) (Nov. 17, 2021)

[Gulf War toxic exposure may be linked to damaging gene expression changes](#) (Aug. 4, 2021)

[+ More](#)

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Questions about the R&D website? [Email the Web Team](#)

Any health information on this website is strictly for informational purposes and is not intended as medical advice. It should not be used to diagnose or treat any condition.

## Veteran programs and services

Homeless Veterans  
Women Veterans  
Minority Veterans  
LGBTQ+ Veterans  
PTSD  
Mental health  
Adaptive sports and special events  
VA outreach events  
National Resource Directory

## More VA resources

VA forms  
VA health care access and quality  
Accredited claims representatives  
VA mobile apps  
State Veterans Affairs offices  
Doing business with VA  
Careers at VA  
VA outreach materials  
Your VA welcome kit

## Get VA updates

VA news  
Press releases  
Email updates  
Facebook  
Instagram  
Twitter  
Flickr  
YouTube  
All VA social media

## In crisis? Get help now

Veterans Crisis Line

## Get answers

Resources and support  
Contact us

## Call us

800-698-2411  
TTY: 711

## Visit a medical center or regional office

Find a VA location

## Language assistance

